Australasian Region

IBS-AR Newsletter

ISSUE 32

DECEMBER 2025

President's Corner

Dear Members

As 2025 comes to a close, I take this opportunity to acknowledge all 206 members of the Australasian IBS region for another year of continuing growth and contributions to the science of Biometry. The strength of our Australasian region was established through the vision of our early founders and is still sustained through the continuing voluntary contributions of time, energy and expertise by our members and the executive committee. I extend special thanks to the members of the AR-IBS Executive committee for their dedication to our region throughout 2025, especially to James Curran, our outgoing Vice-President. I warmly welcome David Warton as our Incoming Vice-President who will take over the role of President in 2027. Our region is very fortunate to have strong representation at the international level. Congratulations to Chris Triggs on his re-election last year as an

Executive member on the IBS Board for another three-year term. Also thanks to our members on the IBS Representative Council: Samuel Muller, Kevin Murray and Vanessa Cave.

We have an active and energetic Executive committee and throughout 2025 we have focussed on developing new initiatives that we are keen to roll out in 2026. Ian Renner and Sam Rogers are leading a team to explore ways of improving membership engagement and value. A survey has been prepared to canvas member ideas and feedback on these new initiatives and was shared at the recent conference. We encourage all members to actively engage with these initiatives in the New Year and welcome any members who would be keen to be more involved to contact any Executive committee member.

A huge thank you to all involved in the organisation of our recent conference, Biometrics in the Bush Capital. Special recognition goes to Emi Tanaka and her team on the Local Organising committee, and to David Warton for leading the Scientific Program committee to put together such a great conference. Congratulations to all of those who received awards for best posters and presentations. Most importantly, I acknowledge all presenters and those who attended to make the conference such a great event.

The next International Biometrics Conference will be held on 12-16 July 2026 in Seoul, South Korea. While abstract submission has now closed, remember to plan for early bird registration before 15 February in the New Year.

The next regional conference, Biometrics by the Bridge will be held in Sydney in late 2027.

A note on our history:

The IBS was founded in 1947 and will be celebrating the 80th anniversary in two years' time. The Australasian region is the fourth oldest region of the IBS, with the initial planning meetings for the AR-IBS beginning in 1948. The constitution for our region was formally adopted at the Melbourne meeting in 1949, so we will be celebrating 80 years of IBS membership in 2029. We are starting to plan celebrations to mark these milestones at our upcoming local conferences.

Our next biennial conference will be hosted in NSW in 2027 and thanks to Garth Tarr and Patrick Ellis for taking on this organisational role. During this conference we will celebrate 80 years of the IBS. Our hope is then that the 2029 conference could return to Melbourne where the first official meeting adopting the AR-IBS constitution was held in

1949. This conference would then mark the 80th anniversary of the AR-IBS, and we are seeking interested people who would be prepared to help plan for this conference in Melbourne in 2029.

In closing, I wish you and your families a revitalising and peaceful holiday break. I extend heartfelt support to those impacted by the recent tragic event at Bondi Beach and the reach this has beyond those who are directly affected. In the IBS we remain firmly guided by principles of equity, diversity, respect and inclusion and we stand with Jewish members of the Society, colleagues and friends. We believe in a community where everyone feels safe, valued and able to belong, and we remain committed to upholding these values.

Best wishes,

Alison Kelly

IBS-AR President

Scholarship Recipients

Every year we offer scholarships to students undertaking a fourth or honours year of study, or a coursework Masters, in statistics, mathematical statistics, biostatistics, bioinformatics or biometrics. This year, the committee received multiple high-quality applications this year, so we took the unusual decision to award multiple scholarships. All the winners are excellent candidates who show great promise for future research in biostatistics.

Congratulations to *Carlo Gamble* (Otago University), *Jiazhe (Jenny) Lin* (ANU) and *Max Coten* (UWA). Please see below for their profiles.

Carlo Gamble:

I am a fourth year Honours student in Statistics at Otago university, currently working on modelling tooth decay through space and time. I first moved from Wellington to Otago to study Chemistry but, after taking a 1st year biostatistics course, I found that Stats was what I really enjoyed and have pursued it since. Graduating with a BSc in Statistics last year. Outside of university I enjoy applying statistics to more trivial pursuits, simulating and deriving probabilities for various tabletop games.

Jiazhe (Jenny) Lin:

My name is Jenny Lin, and I'm currently a Statistics Honours student at the Australian National University (ANU). My surname, "Lin," is represented by the Chinese character "林," which means "forest." Perhaps this explains my natural affinity for environmental science and agriculture, even though my undergraduate studies have mainly revolved around computer science and statistics. I truly enjoy using statistical methods and data science to tackle challenging problems, particularly those found in agriculture. My hope is to contribute meaningfully to biostatistics, whether through further study or practical experience in the field. Ultimately, I aspire to ask meaningful questions, and perhaps even find some valuable answers along the way.

Max Coten:

Max Coten is currently completing his Honours in the Bachelor of Philosophy, majoring in Mathematics and Statistics at the University of Western Australia. With a strong personal interest in the ocean, Max sought to combine this passion with statistics for his Honours thesis. Under the guidance of statistician Dr Lachlan Astfalck and

physical oceanographer Professor Nicole Jones, his project focuses on ocean mixing on the North-West Shelf. The aim is to understand the marginal distribution of ocean mixing and how these properties vary over time.

The motivation behind this research is to gain an improved understanding of the dispersion of ocean tracers such as heat and micronutrients, which directly influence the wellbeing of local marine ecosystems. In July this year, Max will present this research at the Environmental and Ecological Statistics Conference in the UK.

Outside of his academic work, Max is also an elite marathon and ultramarathon swimmer. He is currently ranked in the top 10 nationally for the 10 km swim, and in February this year, he won the world-renowned Rottnest Channel Swim. His dual exposure to statistics and open water swimming has led to involvement in sport science projects at UWA that focus on the onset of medical conditions during marathon swims. Max intends to pursue a PhD in statistics after graduation, ideally focussing on environmental and oceanographic statistics.

Please look out for the scholarship call early next year and encourage your students and colleagues to apply.

Conference Updates

IBS-AR 2025 Conference: Biometrics at the Bush Capital

As noted by the Chair of the Local Organising Committee (LOC) – Emi Tanaka:

It was an absolute pleasure to organise and get to welcome delegates to the Biometrics in the Bush Capital (BIBC2025), 24-28th November 2025 at the National Film and Sound Archive. The meeting featured a diverse scientific program including keynote presentations from Cheng Soon Ong (CSIRO and ANU), Heather L. Turner (University of Warwick), Mevin B. Hooten (The University of Texas at Austin), Jesse Goodman (University of Auckland) and Charmaine B. Dean (University of Waterloo).

The slides and photos are available on the website, so if you missed it, please do have a look:

https://biometricsociety.org.au/conference2025/photos/

Caption: IBS-AR conference delegates at the National Film and Sound Archive of Australia.

The organisation of the conference was made possible thanks to the efforts of the local organising committee, pictured below. I would like to extend my sincere thanks to each of them, as well as to our photographer, Can Li.

Caption: Local Organising Committee (from the left): Quan Vu, Yidi Deng, Patrick Weihao Li, Emi Tanaka, Fonti Kar, Warren Muller, and Alan Welsh. Joanne Thandrayen was also part of the LOC but missing from the above photo.

Thank you to also the Scientific and Program Committee chaired by David Warton, as well as the judging committee for the prizes and awards.

Congratulations are in order for the up-and-coming next generation:

- **Student Speaker Award (joint winners)**: Clayton Forknall and Nelson Chua (honourable mentions Piumi Perera and Martin Huang)
- **People's Choice Poster Prize:** Maggie Xueqi Ma
- **Student Poster Prize:** Jun Tamura (honourable mention Jenny Jiazhe)

Thank you to our sponsors, Australian National University, Grains Development & Development Corporation, University of Auckland and Statistical Society of Australia ACT Branch, that made this conference possible.

Joint SSA-IBS-AR Meeting

On 12 August 2025, a joint meeting of the WA Branch of the Statistical Society of Australia (SSA) and the Australasian Region of the International Biometric Society (IBS-AR) was held at the University of Western Australia. Members heard from Emeritus Professor Adrian Baddeley, who presented a talk entitled "Failing to Connect the Dots: The Strange History of Statistical Methods for Point Patterns."

The meeting was well attended by members of both societies, and we thank Professor Baddeley for an engaging and thought-provoking presentation.

Membership Update

Welcome to our new members who have joined between June 2024 and December 2025:

Oyelola Adegboye
Hassan Ajulo
Zachary Aldiss
Michael Bertolacci
Dila Bhandari
Stephanie Brunner
Zhanglong Cao
Tong Chen
Nelson Chua

Robert Clark
Max Coten
Sarah Croft
Sumonkanti Das
Alysha De Livera
Yidi Deng
Joane Elleouet
Owen Forbes
Jack Freestone
Carlo Gamble
Adam Glucksman
Aarti Gulyani
Daniel Gyaase
Md. Monowar Hosssain
Shaoqian Huang
Martin Huang
Peter Humburg
Takuma Ishihara
Piyadi Gamage Jayani Lakshika
Fonti Kar
Daniel Kim
Jenny Lin
Han Lu
Xueqi Ma
Patrick Maher
Sean Martin
Sam Mason
Aaron McMillan
Michael Mumford
Jacob Munro
Linh Nghiem
Xu Ning
Rocio Noriega
Mahdi Nouraie
Yuki Ohno
Nicholas Olsen
Amarathunaga Perera
Zhangcheng Qiang
Jonathan Roco
Elle Saber
Farwa Saleem
Agus Salim
Matthew Schofield
Arjun Sekhar
Ian Shannon

Eve Slavich
Adam Sparks
Ao Sun
Xiaoya Sun
Jun Tamura
Sandra Tanz
Zhi Yang Tho
Braden Thorne
Raphael Trouve
Wataru Urasaki
Alec van Helsdingen
Zhining Wang
Martin Westgate
Coralie Williams
Kouji Yamamoto
Irene S.L. Zeng
Wenqi Zhao
Huanhuan Zhao
Yufan Zheng

Memberships as of 16 December 2025:

- **Life member:** 4
- **Regular member:** 133
- **Senior retiree:** 17
- **Supporting member:** 4
- **Student member:** 48
- **Grand total:** 206

Australasian Regional Council

The current Australasian Regional Council:

- **President** Alison Kelly (University of Queensland)
- **President elect** David Warton (University of New South Wales)
- **Secretary** Louise McMillan (Victoria University of Wellington)
- **Treasurer** Ian Renner (University of Newcastle)
- **Membership secretary** Sam Rogers (University of Adelaide)
- **Social media officer** Emi Tanaka (Australian National University)

- **Public officer** Warren Müller (CSIRO)
- **Bulletin correspondent** Charley Budgeon (University of Western Australia)
- **Website manager** Peter Green (AgResearch Ltd)
- **IBS Executive board** Chris Triggs (University of Auckland)
- **IBS Biometric Bulletin Executive editor** - Garth Tarr (University of Sydney)

IBS Representative Council members:

- Samuel Muller (Macquarie University)
- Kevin Murray (University of Western Australia)
- Vanessa Cave (VSNi)

Membership portal

The membership portal is where you can update your personal details and manage membership renewal payments. You can even arrange to direct debit membership payments which require no reminders or manual input. To activate direct debit membership, simply log in to your member page and change your membership type to "Regular/Senior Retiree (Automatic Renewal)".

You can also now pay for membership up to three membership years in advance. For extended membership payments or any other membership queries, please contact the membership officer via membership@biometricsociety.org.au

Your membership renewal date is:

1 Mar 2026.

IBS-AR Homepage

IBS-AR Member Code of Conduct

If you would like to share news or events relevant to the IBS-AR community please contact the bulletin correspondent (charley.budgeon@uwa.edu.au).

This email was sent to charley.budgeon@uwa.edu.au. If you would no longer like to receive the IBS-AR Newsletters, you can unsubscribe.